MIL-T-13285B(MU)
24 OCTOBER 1963
SUPERSEDING
MIL-T-13285A(ORD)
11 SEPTEMBER 1959

MILITARY SPECIFICATION

TRIPODS, M15 AND M17

1. SCOPE

1.1 This specification covers tripods used to support telescopes in operation (see 6.1).

2. APPLICABLE DOCUMENTS

2.1 The following documents, of the issue in effect on date of invitation for bids or request for proposal, form a part of this specification to the extent specified herein.

SPECIFICATIONS

MILITARY

MIL-F-13926 —Fire Control Materiel: General Specification Governing the Manufacture and Inspection of.

MIL-P-14232 —Packaging of Parts, Spare Parts, Equipment and Tools for Weapons and Fire Control, General Specification for.

MIL-I-45208 —Inspection Requirements, General Specifications for.

STANDARDS

MILITARY

MIL-STD-105 —Sampling Procedures and Tables for Inspection by Attributes.

MIL-STD-109 —Quality Assurance Terms and Definitions.

DRAWINGS

U. S. ARMY MUNITIONS COMMAND

D6543811 —Tripod, M15.

D6574387 —Tripod, M17.

LSQAP6574387—List of Supplementary Quality Assurance Provisions for Tripod: M17.

PACKAGING DATA SHEET

MIL-P-14232/P6543811 —Packaging of Tripod: M15.

MIL-P-14232/P6574387 —Packaging of Tripod: M17.

(Copies of specifications, standards, drawings, and publications required by suppliers in connection with specific procurement functions should be obtained from the procuring activity or as directed by the contracting officer.)

3. REQUIREMENTS

3.1 Materials. The materials shall be in accordance with the drawings, material specifications, and general specifications forming a part of this specification.

3.2 Fabrication. The tripod shall be manufactured in accordance with the applicable drawing listed in Section 2 and drawings pertaining thereto. The requirements of this specification are detailed only to the extent considered necessary to insure inherent quality and performance capabilities.

3.3 General specifications. The tripod shall

FSC 6650

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meet the following requirements of Specification MIL–F–13926:

(a) Order of precedence.
(b) Dimensions and tolerances.
(c) Inorganic protective surface finishes.
(d) Part identification and marking.
(e) Workmanship.

3.4 **Environmental.**

3.4.1 *Operating temperatures.* The tripod shall meet the applicable requirements of 3.5 while exposed to and thermally stabilized at ambient temperature of —40° and +150° F.

3.5 **Performance.**

3.5.1 *Tripod, M15.*

3.5.1.1 *Cradle, movement.* The hinge connection of the Cradle Assembly, 7669716 shall be just tight enough to permit smooth functioning when elevating or depressing the cradle by means of the Adjusting Thumbscrew, 7575956.

3.5.1.2 *Cradle support.* The thumbscrew of the Leg Assembly 7669717, when tightened, shall prevent movement of the cradle assembly. The thumbscrew of the Collar Assembly 7635320, when secured, shall support the cradle assembly at any vertically adjusted position.

3.5.1.3 *Leg support.* With each leg displaced at least 65° from the vertical, the hinged assemblies shall be capable of supporting the cradle assembly and shall not displace when a weight of 10 pounds is placed in the cradle.

3.5.2 *Tripod, M17.*

3.5.2.1 *Clamping screws.* All winged clamping screws shall clamp with sufficient pressure to hold legs at any extension when the clamping screws are tightened with the fingers and minimum weight of 30 pounds is applied at the head of the tripod. When the clamping screws are released, the legs shall have a free sliding movement.

3.5.2.2 *Locking levers.* The locking levers in the Head Assembly, Drawing 5581222 shall be capable of securing its respective leg to prevent the leg from displacing under operating conditions.

4. QUALITY ASSURANCE PROVISIONS

4.1 Responsibility for inspection. The supplier is responsible for the performance of all inspection requirements as specified herein. Except as otherwise specified, the supplier may utilize his own or any other inspection facilities and services acceptable to the Government. Inspection records of the eaxminations and tests shall be kept complete and available to the Government as specified in the contract or order. The Government reserves the right to perform any of the inspections set forth in the specification where such inspections are deemed necessary to assure supplies and services conform to precribed requirements.

4.1.1 *General provisions.* The quality assurance provisions of this specification and of other documents referenced herein form the basis for inspection to be performed by the supplier. Inspection shall be in accordance with the requirements of Specification MIL–I–45208 and the component inspection requirements of Specification MIL–F–13926. Definitions of inspection terms not otherwise defined herein shall be as listed in Standard MIL–STD–109.

4.2 **Inspection provisions.**

4.2.1 *Inspection lot.* Unless otherwise specified by the contracting officer, inspection lot size, formation, and presentation of lots shall be in accordance with "Submission of Product" specified in Standard MIL–STD–105.

4.2.2 *Examination and tests.* Components and subassemblies shall be inspected in accordance with the inspection provisions contained in Specification MIL–F–13926 and List of Supplementary Quality Assurance Provisions, LSQAP–6574387 (Tripod: M17 only). Examinations and tests related to Section 3 herein shall be performed on a defect (individual characteristic) basis in accordance

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with Standard MIL–STD–105, and the inspection level and sampling plans specified in Tables I, II and III titled "Classification of Defects". Examinations and tests for Packaging, Packing and Marking shall be in accordance with Specification MIL–P–14232 and Section 5 herein. The tabulated classification of defects shall constitute the minimum inspection to be performed by the supplier prior to Government acceptance or rejection by lot. The Government reserves the right to inspect for any applicable requirement, and to reject individual nonconforming items.

TABLE I. *Classification of Defects*
Use Level II of Table I, with Sampling Plan Table II–A of Standard MIL–STD–105

FOR TRIPOD: M15

	Requirement	Test procedure
CRITICAL: None.		
MAJOR: AQL 1.0 percent defective:		
101. Bind in movement of cable assembly	3.5.1.1	4.5.3.1
102. Cradle support slippage	3.5.1.3	4.5.3.2
103. Leg support slippage	3.5.1.3	4.5.3.3
MINOR: None.		

TABLE II. *Classification of Defects*
Use Level II of Table I, with Sampling Plan Table II–A of Standard MIL–STD–105

FOR TRIPOD: M17

	Requirement	Test procedure
CRITICAL: None.		
MAJOR: AQL 1.0 percent defective:		
104. Clamping screw slippage	3.5.2.1	4.5.3.4
105. Leg fails to slide freely when clamping screws are released	3.5.2.1	4.5.3.4
106. Locking lever slippage	3.5.2.2	4.5.3.5
MINOR: None.		

TABLE III. *Classification of Defects*
Use Inspection Level S4 of Table I, with Sampling Plan Table II–A of Standard MIL–STD–105

FOR TRIPODS: M15 AND M17

	Requirement	Test procedure
CRITICAL: None.		
MAJOR: AQL 2.5%		
107. Operating temperatures	3.4.1 & 3.5	4.5.2
MINOR: None.		

4.2.3 *Disposition of non-conforming product.* Rejected lots shall be screened for all defective characteristics. Removal or correction of defective units and resubmittance of rejected lots shall be in accordance with "Acceptance and Rejection" specified in Standard MIL–STD–105.

4.3 Control tests. Three tripods of each type shall be selected at random for each 100 produced, or from each months production, whichever occurs first. Control samples shall have successfully met all acceptance tests specified herein prior to conducting the following examinations and tests:

Control test	Requirement	Test procedure
(a) Materials	3.1	Per Drawings & Specifications
(b) Fabrication	3.2	4.5.1
(c) Dimensions and tolerances	3.3(b)	SME–MIL–F–13926
(d) Inorganic protective surface finishes	3.3(c)	Visual–MIL–F–13926
(e) Part identification and marking	3.3(d)	Visual–MIL–F–13926
(f) Workmanship	3.3(e)	Visual–MIL–F–13926

4.3.1 *Control test failure.* Should the control test sample fail to meet the specified test requirements, acceptance of the product will be suspended by the Government until necessary corrections have been made by the contractor and the resubmitted samples have been approved.

4.4 Inspection equipment. Except as otherwise provided for by the contract, the contractor shall furnish and maintain all required measuring and testing equipment in accordance with the "Inspection Equipment" requirement of Specification MIL–I–45208. The Government reserves the right to use the test equipment for its own independent inspections to the extent that such use will not unduly interfere with the contractor's delivery schedule.

4.4.1 *Government furnished inspection equipment.* Where the contract provides for

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Government furnished test equipment, care and maintenance of test equipment shall be in accordance with "Inspection Equipment," and "Government Furnished Material" requirements of Specification MIL–I–45208.

4.4.2 *Contractor furnished inspection equipment.*

4.4.2.1 *Contractor design.* The contractor shall design and supply inspection equipment compatible with the "Test Methods and Procedures" specified in 4.5, and with the "Component Inspection" requirements of Specification MIL–F–13926. Concept, construction, materials, dimensions, and tolerances used in design of test equipment shall be so selected and controlled as to insure that the test equipment will permit positive rejection of a product which exceeds the prescribed tolerance limit, and will reliably indicate acceptability of a product which does not exceed 90 percent of the prescribed tolerance limit. Construction shall be such as to facilitate routine calibration of the equipment.

4.4.2.2 *Equipment to perform operating temperatures test.* The test equipment shall be in accordance with the "Test Facilities" requirements which include pertinent volume and tolerances governing the environmental test conditions and measurements contained in Specification MIL–F–13926 for the operating temperatures specified in 3.4.1.

4.5 Test methods and procedures.

4.5.1 *Fabrication.* The tripod shall be visually inspected for proper fabrication in compliance with the requirements specified in 3.2. Dimensional checks shall be made by use of standard measuring equipment. This inspection shall be performed on the control samples (4.3).

4.5.2 *Operating temperatures.* The operating temperature test consists of exposing the tripod to the temperatures indicated in 3.4.1 by means of equipment complying with the requirements of 4.4.2.2. While at these temperatures, each tripod shall meet the applicable performance requirements as specified in 3.4.1.

4.5.3 *Performance.*

4.5.3.1 *Cradle movement (M15).* The tripod shall be firmly set. The tripod shall then be functionally and manually tested for the requirements of 3.5.1.1 by manually operating and noting that movement is without bind or looseness.

4.5.3.2 *Cradle support (M15).* The tripod shall be functionally and manually tested for the requirements of 3.5.1.2. When the thumbscrew of the leg assembly is tightened there shall be no apparent movement of the cradle assembly. It shall move freely when thumbscrew is released. The cradle assembly shall be secured at any extension, and when the thumbscrew of the collar assembly is tightened there shall be no apparent movement of the cradle assembly.

4.5.3.3 *Leg support (M15).* The test shall be accomplished with the aid of standard measuring equipment. The leg hinge assemblies shall be stiff enough to support the weight specified in 3.5.1.3 with the legs of the tripod displaced from the vertical as specified in 3.5.1.3.

4.5.3.4 *Clamping screws (M17).* The test may be performed with the legs of the tripod set at least on a 30-inch circle. Apply the required weight as specified in 3.5.2.1. The clamping assembly shall function properly, and securely clamp the legs at any extension when the winged screws are tightened. When the winged screws are released, the legs shall slide freely.

4.5.3.5 *Locking levers (M17).* The tripod shall be functionally and manually tested for the requirements of 3.5.2.2, utilizing the same test setup as in 4.5.3.4. The locking lever when in locked position shall hold with sufficient tension to prevent its respective leg from being jarred from its set position or displaced.

5. PREPARATION FOR DELIVERY

5.1 **Packaging, packing and marking.** The tripod shall be cleaned preserved, packaged, packed and marked in accordance with Specification MIL–P–14232 and the applicable data

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sheet. The level of protection shall be as specified in the procurement document.

6. NOTES

6.1 Intended use. Tripod: M15 is used with Observation Telescope: M49 and Tripod: M17 is used with Battery Commanders, Telescope: M65.

6.2 Ordering data. Procurement document should specify the following:

(a) Title, number, and date of this specification.

(b) Tripod model required for procurement.

(c) Selection of applicable levels of preservation, packaging, and packing.

(d) Applicable stock number.

(e) Applicable packaging data sheet number (see 2.1).

Custodian:
Army—MU

Preparing activity:
Army—MU
Project No. 6650–A132Y

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SPECIFICATION ANALYSIS SHEET

Form Approved
Budget Bureau No. 119-R004

INSTRUCTIONS

This sheet is to be filled out by personnel either Government or contractor, involved in the use of the specification in procurement of products for ultimate use by the Department of Defense. This sheet is provided for obtaining information on the use of this specification which will insure that suitable products can be procured with a minimum amount of delay and at the least cost. Comments and the return of this form will be appreciated. Fold on lines on reverse side, staple in corner, and send to preparing activity *(as indicated on reverse hereof)*.

SPECIFICATION

ORGANIZATION *(Of submitter)*	CITY AND STATE

CONTRACT NO.	QUANTITY OF ITEMS PROCURED	DOLLAR AMOUNT
		$

MATERIAL PROCURED UNDER A

☐ DIRECT GOVERNMENT CONTRACT ☐ SUBCONTRACT

1. HAS ANY PART OF THE SPECIFICATION CREATED PROBLEMS OR REQUIRED INTERPRETATION IN PROCUREMENT USE?

A. GIVE PARAGRAPH NUMBER AND WORDING.

B. RECOMMENDATIONS FOR CORRECTING THE DEFICIENCIES.

2. COMMENTS ON ANY SPECIFICATION REQUIREMENT CONSIDERED TOO RIGID

3. IS THE SPECIFICATION RESTRICTIVE?

☐ YES ☐ NO IF "YES", IN WHAT WAY?

4. REMARKS *(Attach any pertinent data which may be of use in improving this specification. If there are additional papers, attach to form and place both in an envelope addressed to preparing activity)*

SUBMITTED BY *(Printed or typed name and activity)*	DATE

DD FORM 1 APR 63 1426 REPLACES NAVSHIPS FORM 4863, WHICH IS OBSOLETE C-9279

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